

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

STAFF REPORT

December 5, 1997

ITEM: 14

SUBJECT: Waste Discharge Requirements for Farm Mutual Water Company, Riverside County, Order No. 97-79

DISCUSSION:

The Farm Mutual Water Company owns and operates a wastewater treatment facility located in the Bundy Canyon area of Riverside County near Lake Elsinore (see Attachment "A"). This wastewater treatment facility services the Farm Mobilehome Development. This facility is currently regulated under waste discharge requirements, Order No. 84-56, adopted by the Board on May 11, 1984.

The design capacity of the facility is 218,000 gallons per day (gpd). During dry weather, treated wastewater is disposed of by spray irrigation of natural vegetation in a confined fenced area located adjacent to the wastewater treatment facility. The facility currently produces approximately 100,000 gallons per day of secondary treated wastewater. During wet weather, all treated wastewater is discharged to the evaporation/percolation ponds. Order No. 84-56 is being updated to reflect changes in the Water Quality Control Plan (Basin Plan).

The Farm Mutual Mobilehome Development's treatment plant lies within the boundaries of both the Santa Ana and San Diego Regional Boards. Since the treatment plant, and disposal areas are within this Board's jurisdiction, the Santa Ana Regional Board has assumed responsibility for regulating this discharger. The wastewater treatment plant and disposal areas overlie a minor groundwater area for which beneficial uses and water quality objectives have not been established. This area is tributary to the Elsinore Groundwater Subbasin, the beneficial uses of which include municipal and domestic supply, agricultural supply, and industrial process supply.

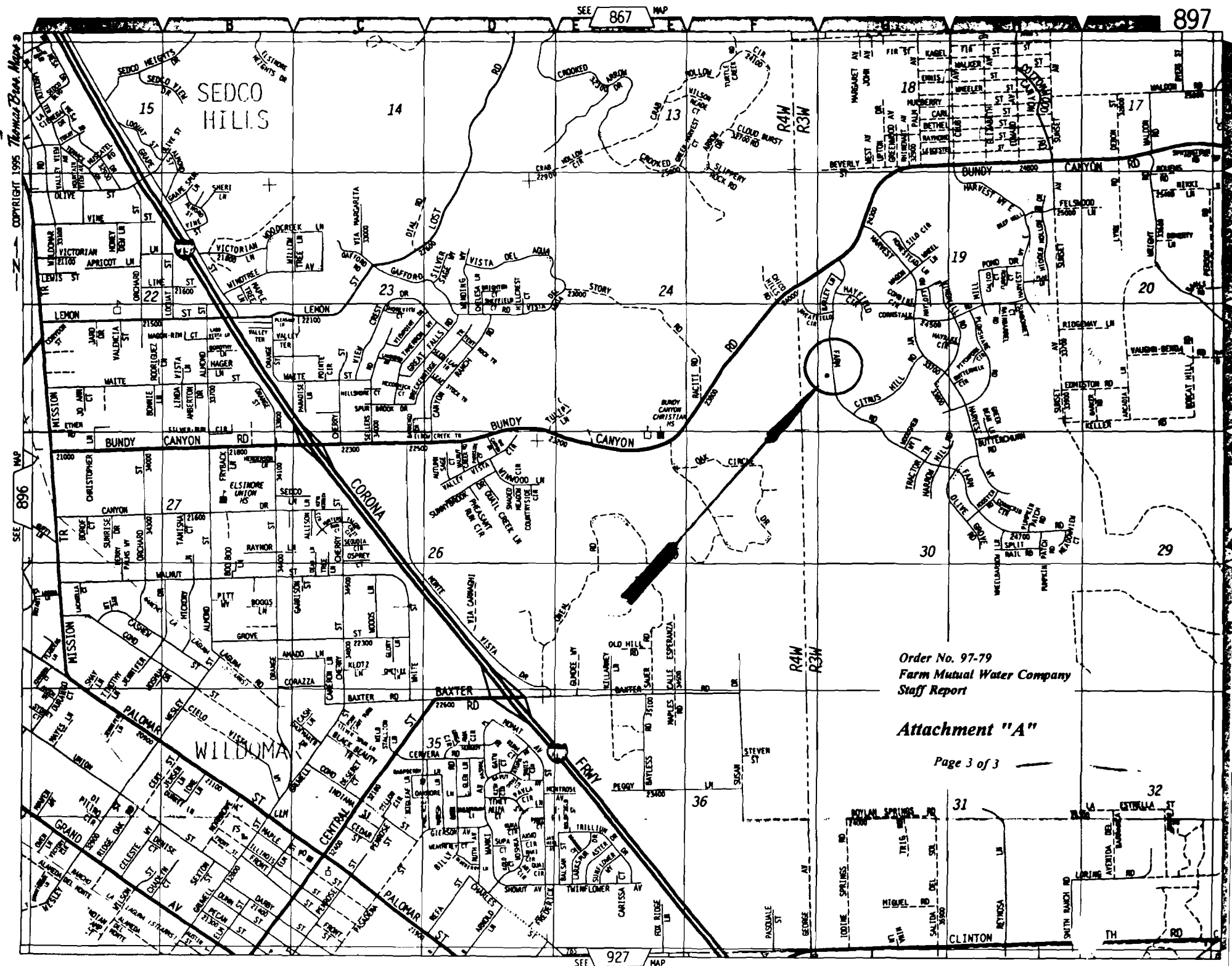
The proposed limits in this order are based on the Water Quality Control Plan for the Santa Ana Basin and other applicable state and federal regulations and are necessary to protect the beneficial uses of the affected receiving waters.

RECOMMENDATION:

Adopt Order No. 97-79, as presented.

Comments were solicited from the following agencies:

State Water Resources Control Board, Office of the Chief Counsel - Ted Cobb
State Water Resources Control Board, Division of Water Quality - John Youngerman
State Department of Water Resources - Glendale
State Department of Health Services - San Diego
California Regional Water Quality Control Board, San Diego Region (9)
Riverside County Environmental Health Services - John Silva
Riverside County Flood Control and Water Conservation District - Mark Wills
South Coast Air Quality Management District - James Lents
Eastern Municipal Water District - John Brodin
Elsinore Valley Municipal Water District - John Hoagland
Western Municipal Water District - Donald Harriger
City of Lake Elsinore - City Manager



California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

Order No. 97-79

Waste Discharge Requirements
for
Farm Mutual Water Company
Riverside County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Santa Ana Region (hereinafter the Board), finds that:

1. The Farm Mutual Water Company (hereinafter the discharger), owns and operates a wastewater treatment facility which services the Farm Mobilehome Development. This facility is currently regulated under waste discharge requirements, Order No. 84-56, adopted by the Board on May 11, 1984.
2. The wastewater treatment process consists of mechanical bar screen, oxidation ditch, aeration, secondary clarifier, and chlorine disinfection. The design capacity of the facility is 218,000 gallons per day (gpd). The facility currently produces approximately 100,000 gallons per day of treated wastewater. During dry weather, treated wastewater is disposed of by spray irrigation of natural vegetation in a confined fenced area located adjacent to the wastewater treatment facility. During wet weather, all treated effluent is discharged to percolation/evaporation ponds.
3. The disposal areas are located within portions of Section 19, 29, and 30, T6S, R3W, SBB&M, in the Bundy Canyon area of Riverside County near Lake Elsinore.
4. A revised Water Quality Control Plan (Basin Plan) became effective on January 24, 1995. This plan contains beneficial uses and water quality objectives for waters in the Santa Ana Region. The requirements contained in this order are necessary to implement the Water Quality Control Plan.
5. The requirements contained in this order are necessary to implement the Basin Plan.
6. The disposal ponds overlie a minor groundwater area for which beneficial uses and water quality objectives have not been established. This area is tributary to the Elsinore Groundwater Subbasin, the beneficial uses of which include:
 - a. Municipal and domestic supply.
 - b. Agricultural supply, and
 - c. Industrial process supply.

7. It is necessary and appropriate to require control of mineral constituents in order to meet water quality objectives and to protect the beneficial uses of the affected receiving water.
8. The requirements contained in this order are necessary to implement the Water Quality Control Plan.
9. This project involves the continued operation of existing facilities and, as such, is exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (Public Resources Code, Section 21100 et seq.) in accordance with Section 15301, Chapter 3, Title 14, California Code of Regulations.
10. The Board notified the discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe revised waste discharge requirements for the discharge and provided them with an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
11. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that the discharger shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Specifications

1. The discharge of wastewater containing constituent concentrations in excess of the following limit is prohibited:

Constituent	Monthly Average
Biochemical Oxygen Demand	30 mg/l

- 2.a. The discharge of wastes or use of wastewater containing constituent concentrations in excess of the following limit is prohibited:

Constituent	12-Month Average
Total Dissolved Solids	700 mg/l

- 2.b. The discharge of wastes containing a 12-month average total dissolved solids concentration which exceeds the 12-month average total dissolved solids concentration in the water supply by more than 250 mg/l is prohibited.

For Discharge Specification No. 2.a. and 2.b., whichever total dissolved solids limit that results in the lower concentration shall be controlling.

3. The pH of the discharge shall at all times be within the range of 6 and 9 pH units.
4. The discharge of wastewater to any pond with less than one foot of freeboard is prohibited.
5. The discharge of waste to property not owned or controlled by the discharger is prohibited.

B. Reporting Requirements

The discharger shall report any noncompliance which may endanger health or the environment. Any such information shall be provided orally to the Executive Officer or authorized representative within 24 hours from the time the discharger becomes aware of the circumstances. A written submission shall also be provided within five days of the time the discharger becomes aware of the circumstances. The written submission shall contain a description of the noncompliance and its cause; the period of noncompliance, including exact dates and times, and if the noncompliance has not been corrected; the anticipated time it is expected to continue; and steps taken or planned to reduce, eliminate, and prevent recurrence of the noncompliance. The Executive Officer, or an authorized representative, may waive the written report on a case-by-case basis if the oral report has been received within 24 hours.

C. Provisions

1. The discharger shall comply with Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 97-79 as issued by the Executive Officer. Revision of this monitoring and reporting program by the Executive Officer may be necessary to confirm that the discharger is in compliance with the requirements and provisions contained in this order. Revisions may be made at any time during the term of this order, and may include a reduction or an increase in the number of parameters to be monitored, the frequency of monitoring or the number and size of samples collected.
2. Neither the treatment nor the discharge of wastes shall cause a nuisance or pollution as defined in Section 13050 of the California Water Code.
3. The treatment plant and disposal facilities shall be protected from a 100-year frequency flood.
4. The discharger shall give advance notice to the Regional Board as soon as possible of any planned physical alterations or additions to the permitted facility or changes in operation or activity that may result in noncompliance with these waste discharge requirements.

5. The discharger shall file with the Board a report of waste discharge at least 120 days before making any material change or proposed change in the character, location or volume of the discharge or in the method of disposal of the discharge, or any proposed change in ownership of the facility.
6. The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize or correct any adverse impact on the environment resulting from noncompliance with this order, including such accelerated or additional monitoring as may be necessary to determine the nature and impact of the noncompliance.
7. The discharger shall maintain a copy of this order at the site so that it is available at all times to site operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its content.
8. The provisions of this order are severable, and if any provision of this order, or the application of any provisions of this order to any circumstance, is held invalid, the application of such provision to other circumstances, and the remainder of this order shall not be affected thereby.
9. The discharger shall insure that all facilities and systems of treatment, distribution, and control (and related appurtenances) which are installed or used to achieve compliance with conditions of this order are at all times properly operated and maintained. Proper operation and maintenance includes effective performance, adequate funding, adequate operator staffing and training, and adequate laboratory and process controls, including appropriate quality assurance procedures. This provision requires the operation of backup and auxiliary facilities or similar systems only when necessary to achieve compliance with the conditions of this order.
10. Collected screenings, sludge, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer of the Regional Board.
11. The discharger shall take all reasonable steps to minimize or prevent any discharge that has a reasonable likelihood of adversely affecting human health or the environment.
12. The Board, and other authorized representatives shall be allowed:
 - a. Entry upon premises where a regulated facility or activity is located or conducted, including treatment or discharge facilities, sludge use and disposal activities, or facilities where records must be kept under the conditions of this permit;
 - b. Access to copy any records that are kept under the conditions of this order;
 - c. To inspect any facility, equipment (including monitoring and control equipment), practices, or operations regulated or required under this order; and

- d. To photograph, sample and monitor for the purpose of assuring compliance with this order.
13. The discharger shall file with the Board by March 31, 1998, a technical report on its preventive (failsafe) and contingency (cleanup) plans for controlling accidental discharges and for minimizing the effect of such events. The technical report shall:
- a. Identify the possible sources of accidental loss, untreated waste bypass, and contaminated drainage. Loading and storage areas, power outage, waste treatment outage, and failure of process equipment, tanks, and pipes should be considered.
 - b. Evaluate the effectiveness of present facilities and procedures and state when they become operational. Describe facilities and procedures needed for effective preventive and contingency plans.
 - c. Predict the effectiveness of the proposed facilities and procedures and provide an implementation schedule containing interim and final dates when they will be constructed, implemented, or operational.
14. Order No. 84-56 is hereby rescinded.

I, Gerard J. Thibeault, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Santa Ana Region, on December 5, 1997.



Gerard J. Thibeault
Executive Officer

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Santa Ana Region

Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 97-79

for

Farm Mutual Water Company
Wastewater Treatment Facility
Riverside County

A. Effluent Monitoring

1. A sampling station shall be established for each point of discharge and shall be located where representative samples of the discharge can be obtained.
2. The following shall constitute the effluent monitoring program:

Constituent	Units	Type of Sample	Minimum Frequency of Sample
Flow	gallons	Flowmeter	Continuous
Biochemical Oxygen Demand	mg/l	Composite	Weekly
Specific Conductance	μ mhos/cm	Composite	Monthly
Total Dissolved Solids	mg/l	Composite	Monthly
Nitrate	mg/l	Composite	Annually
Total Hardness	mg/l	Composite	Annually
Chloride	mg/l	Composite	Annually
Sodium	mg/l	Composite	Annually
Sulfate	mg/l	Composite	Annually

3. Weekly samples shall be collected on representative days of the week.
4. Monthly samples shall be collected on the first working day of each month.
5. Annual samples shall be collected on the first working day of January.
6. The freeboard in each pond shall be measured every Friday of each week and recorded in a permanent log.
7. A permanent log of all wastes hauled from the facility for final disposal elsewhere shall be maintained. This should include volume, type, and final disposal site of each waste.

B. Water Supply Monitoring

A monthly sample of the water supply to the sewer area serviced by the treatment plant shall be collected and shall be analyzed for total dissolved solids and electrical conductivity.

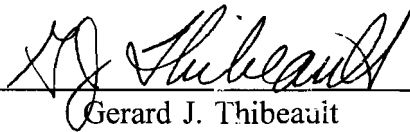
C. Reporting

1. Monitoring reports shall be submitted by the dates in the following schedule:

Report	Reporting Frequency	Report Due Date
Weekly Effluent Analysis and Flow	Monthly	By the 30th day of the month following the monitoring period
Monthly Effluent Analysis	Monthly	"
Bio-Solids Disposal	Monthly	"
Water Supply Parameters	Annually	"

2. For every item where the requirements are not met, the discharger shall submit a statement of the actions undertaken or proposed which will bring the discharge into full compliance with requirements at the earliest time and submit a timetable for correction.
3. The annual report for water supply parameters shall include a roster of plant personnel, including job titles, duties, and level of state certification for each individual.

All reports shall be signed by a responsible officer or duly authorized representative of the discharger and shall be submitted under penalty of perjury.

Ordered by 
Gerard J. Thibeault
Executive Officer

December 5, 1997